Port Hills Spring Rogaine 2015

Thank you for your entry. Please get your team number from the website teams list and enter it on the indemnity form.

Please ensure all team members are familiar with the information below.

Getting to the event

REGISTRATION and START/FINISH is at the main car park at Victoria Park (see map on webpage if you are unsure).

As the general public will also want to use the car park during the day, we would really appreciate it if a) you could car pool to the event (even if it's only meeting at the bottom of the hill and transferring to one car) and b) if you could move your car onto the road beside Sign of the Takahe before starting.

There is limited shelter available at registration.

Registration

At registration ensure your team is together and that you have your completed Indemnity and Emergency Contact form (included below) with you and that your team number is written on the form. Your team will be issued with: an event map (TWO A4 size, 1:15,000 scale maps oriented to grid north with magnetic north lines marked on the map), a checkpoint description sheet, and an A4 zip lock plastic bag per team member.

A clip-card per team. The card will have your team number on it. All members of your team must attend the event briefing. The clip card will be stamped at the registration so make sure your card is stamped.

Finish

As soon as you finish, make sure your card is marked by with your finish time by one of the finish crew. After this your card will be given back to you for you to add up your score. Return your card to the finish desk.

Your event will close after the 6 or 3hrs has elapsed. Aim to finish on time as you will be penalised 10 points per minute late and if you are over 30 minutes late you lose all your points.

Event chronology

	6 hour	**3 hour**
Registration opens	8:30am	10:30am
Briefing	9:45am	11:45am
Start	10am	12 noon
Finish	4pm	3pm

Post-event food
– for 6 hour competitors: soup, roll and muffin
– for 3 hour competitors: muffin

What to bring

Essential clothing and safety equipment is listed under 'Safety Sheet'.

You will also find handy:

- a range of marker pens, pencils and highlighters, pins and string, and ruler, for planning and
- measuring your route before you start
- eating utensils for the meal after the event (at the least a mug)
- optional - folding outdoor seats, and maybe a folding camp table for course planning
- Navigation devices such as altimeters or GPS, including altimeters within watches and GPS within cellphones, are not allowed to be used.

Food and drink.

Carry enough for a long day in the field. You may return to the start-finish at any time for a rest, or a drink. There is water available at the Sign of the Kiwi which will be marked on the map.

Hazards

A more extensive list of hazards is detailed in the safety sheet below. We would particularly like to bring to your attention that

ROADS ARE NOT CLOSED during the event. Dyers Pass road is out of bounds at all places other than at the saddle adjacent to Sign of the Kiwi. The Summit Road is not marked as out of bounds on the map and can be crossed at any point. In most cases we think it will be better to travel on the adjacent tracks but if you are walking or running on the Summit road please travel in single file and keep well off the tar seal. Be extremely careful crossing Dyers Pass Road at the saddle and the Summit road at any point. Be aware of both car and cycle traffic – cycles can be travelling fast along the Summit road and you are unlikely to hear them coming.

Mountain bikers are likely to be using many of the tracks. Give way and be aware at all times.

Many of the tracks can be slippery and especially those that pass through areas of native bush. Be aware, especially if you start to tire.

Event procedure

We recommend you spend at least 45 minutes (6 hour event) 30 minutes (3 hour event) planning your route, making the day more enjoyable and rewarding.

You should plan your route carefully, aiming to challenge your map reading and navigation skills but staying within the safe limits set by the terrain and weather, and your experience and fitness. If your team lacks confidence in finding its way in moderate, untracked tramping terrain, you might confine your route to the more easily accessible check points.

Your team may visit any number of check points and in any order. Your aim is to maximise your 'score'. The checkpoints each have a unique number and the score value is the first digit followedby a zero. Thus checkpoint number 23 has a score of 20 points and 91 a score of 90 points. Checkpoints numbered 100 or above are worth 100 points. All teams start together. Concentrate on your own team plan. On the course do not try to follow other teams, or get distracted by them as they may have set a different route. Tracks and fences may exist which are not marked on the map, and others are mapped that no longer exist. Tracks and fences may serve as useful navigational aids, but do not assume their detailed accuracy.

There is a distinction between "the" and "a" in describing checkpoint locations, e.g., "The lone pine" means it is marked as a tree on the map, whereas "A lone pine" means that one exists, but it isn't marked on the map.

Team members must always stay within verbal contact of each other on the course, and must simultaneously approach to within 5 metres of each checkpoint visited. At each checkpoint there is an orange/white flag tied to a bush or post etc. (usually at knee to shoulder height) and a punch. These should be visible from at least 10 meters away, depending on your approach. As they have been placed in the field up to two weeks prior, we cannot be certain that all are still intact. If a checkpoint is missing you must be able to describe its presumed location to the score keepers to be credited with the points. A photo of the location may aid in convincing the score keepers that you were at the correct location.

When you visit a checkpoint, 'punch' your card in the box matching the number of the checkpoint.

A full set of rules governing Rogaining in New Zealand is available under "Resources" at www.rogaine.org.nz.

Safety Sheet

Port Hills Spring Rogaine 6 and 3 hour Rogaines - Saturday 5th September 2015

Cancellation

This event will be cancelled only if conditions are extreme. The organisers reserve the right to shorten the event by time or geography for safety or other reasons.

Compulsory clothes and equipment:

Per team member:

- thermal top
- thermal hat and gloves
- shower proof/windproof coat
- survival sheet or pack liner
- whistle

Per team:

- Mobile phone
- first aid kit
- at least one compass
- watch
- pencil or fine spirit marker

Your gear is your own responsibility. There will be no compulsory gear check but the organisers reserve the right to do checks on a random or selective basis. You must be suitably equipped to start.

We recommend you also carry: a fully rainproof parka, second layer thermal top, thermal trousers, a compass each, watch each.

Organisers can be reached on **021 642516**.

Safety is a top priority. Organisers and participants (you) have responsibilities for safety, including:

- being aware of and meeting all safety requirements specified by event organisers in writing, on the event web site, or at verbal briefings,
- carrying all compulsory protective clothing and other safety equipment,
- advising your team member(s) of any medical conditions you have, your general level of fitness and other factors that may affect you adversely during the event,
- staying together as a team at all times, and providing mutual support, and helping any other team you find in difficulties,
- advising organisers and returning your card if you withdraw from the event, or when you finish. This is our safety check that you are no longer on the course and IS COMPULSORY,
- being highly conscious of time and avoiding a late return – being late results in a hefty points penalty as well as raising safety concerns,
- being prepared to modify your plans to be more conservative if safety conditions dictate this, monitoring team and individual progress and fitness and modifying plans as required,
- looking out for hazards, such as:

1. Hypothermia. Wind, water and cold temperatures can lead to exposure or hypothermia.

Early symptoms are subtle (clumsiness, lethargy, slurred speech). Be prepared to seek shelter or to call it a day if conditions are severe, or if any of your team is becoming exhausted. In severe weather, keep off the high points on the map.

2. Dehydration. Drink lots of water – we suggest you carry at least 2 litres per person. Water is available at the Sign of the Kiwi.

3. Streams.

4. Cliffs, slippery rocks, loose rocks, incised creeks, gullies, slippery grass, hidden obstacles such as logs, loose fencing wire, etc. may be present throughout the event area.

5. Collapsed tunnels or ‘under-runners’, especially on farm tracks

6. Fog/low cloud. If in fog, orientate the map and yourself with a compass. If in doubt, don’t climb into cloud, and descend out of it as soon as possible.

7. Road Hazard: There will be traffic on roads. No roads are closed during the event.

8. The Road Code applies at all times: keep to the side of the road and be alert to traffic.

9. Stinging nettle/Onga Onga – in native bush

In the event of significant injury or exhaustion, make the injured person warm and comfortable; arrange, if possible, to leave someone with the person; note your exact location on the map; seek help via the nearest road. Emergency signal – repeated (6 or more) short blasts on whistle at about 1 second intervals, repeated each 1 to 5 minutes. Repeat if you hear one long blast. If you become totally disorientated, travel down slope to sheltered ground, preferably to a road.

Environmental and farm care

Rogaining is an environmentally & socially friendly activity – please reinforce this ethic.

Respect, fences and other facilities, and the right of landowners to operate their business, and lifestyle..

LEAVE GATES AS YOU FIND THEM. They will usually be shut. Shut them if you have any doubt.

Cross fences, where you must, at a strainer post, or climb through. Do not spring off the top wire.

Protect plants and animals

Remove rubbish – more importantly, don't create it in the first place

Bury toilet waste - better still, don't create it in the field - use the toilets provided at the event centre and at the Sign of the Kiwi where possible. Keep streams clean

Thank you,

Organisers Port Hill Spring Rogaine, in association with the NZRA